Data Retention and Disposal Policy

Organization: Meridian Technologies

Document ID: IT-003

Version: 1.0

Department: IT and Security

Team: Infrastructure

Effective Date: March 1, 2026

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1. Purpose

This policy establishes how Meridian Technologies stores, retains, archives and disposes of organizational information.

The Infrastructure team maintains the technical storage systems, while individual departments remain responsible for identifying the business requirements associated with their records.

2. Data Classification

Organizational information is classified into four categories:

Classification	Description
Public	Approved for general internal access
Internal	Intended for authorized employees

Confidential	Contains sensitive business information
Restricted	Accessible only to explicitly authorized individuals

Documents must retain their assigned classification throughout their storage lifecycle.

3. Retention Schedule

The following internal retention periods apply:

Record Type	Retention Period
Application audit logs	12 months
General application logs	90 days
Financial transaction records	7 years
Employee administra	5 years after separation

tive records	
Security incident records	3 years
Infrastructure backup snapshots	90 days
Archived business documents	According to department schedule

Records subject to an investigation or legal hold must not be deleted until the hold is formally released.

4. Storage Requirements

Business documents must be stored in approved organizational storage systems.

Restricted documents must retain their access restrictions when archived or transferred between storage locations.

Sensitive information must not be copied into personal cloud storage or unauthorized external systems.

5. Data Disposal

Data that has reached the end of its approved retention period may be disposed of after confirmation from the responsible department.

Disposal methods may include:

- Secure file deletion.
- Approved storage sanitization.
- Database record deletion.

- Cryptographic key destruction where applicable.

Disposal activities involving restricted records must be documented.

6. Backup and Recovery

The Infrastructure team must maintain backups according to the approved backup schedule.

Backups must be protected against unauthorized access and accidental modification.

Backup retention is governed by the schedule in Section 3.

Recovery procedures are documented separately in IT-004.

7. Responsibilities

Team	Responsibility
Infrastructure	Storage, backup and disposal operations
Cybersecurity	Security classification and monitoring
Finance	Financial record retention
Human Resources	Employee record retention
Department Heads	Business record

	ownership

8. Exceptions

Retention exceptions require approval from the responsible department and IT and Security.

Records involved in legal proceedings, security investigations or financial audits must be preserved until the relevant authority confirms that disposal is permitted.

9. Related Documents

- IT-001: Enterprise Access Control Policy
- IT-004: Backup and Disaster Recovery Procedures
- IT-005: Security Incident Handling Playbook
- FIN-001: Quarterly Financial Planning and Expense Report

10. Version History

Version	Date	Description
1.0	2026-03-01	Initial retention policy

Document Owner: Infrastructure Manager